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Embolic protection device and method

Abstract

A collapsible, transluminally deliverable embolic protection device (**200**) for temporarily positioning in the aortic arch is disclosed. The device is connectable to a transluminal delivery unit (**130**) extending proximally from a connection point (**131**). The device has a frame with a periphery, and a blood permeable unit within said periphery for preventing embolic particles from passing therethrough into side vessels of said aortic arch to the brain of a patient. Further, the device has at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of said device, for application of a force offset to said connection point at said device, such as at said periphery, towards an inner wall of said aortic arch when said device is positioned in said aortic arch, such that tissue apposition of said periphery to an inner wall of said aortic arch is supported by said force. In addition related methods are disclosed.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of and claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/102,593 filed Aug. 13, 2018 entitled Improved Embolic Protection Device And Method, which is a continuation of and claims priority to U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/442,849 filed May 14, 2015 entitled Improved Embolic Protection Device And Method (now U.S. Pat. No. 10,076,400 issued Sep. 18, 2018), which is the U.S. National Phase of and claims priority to International Patent Application No. PCT/EP2013/073895, International Filing Date Nov. 14, 2013, entitled Improved Embolic Protection Device And Method, which claims benefit of European Patent Application No. EP12192690.1, filed Nov. 14, 2012 entitled Improved Embolic Protection Device And Method; and U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 61/726,537, filed Nov. 14, 2012 entitled Improved Embolic Protection Device And Method; all of which are incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

(1) This invention pertains in general to the field of embolic protection devices. More particularly the invention generally relates to systems and methods for cerebral protection by deflection of embolic debris, such as during an endovascular procedure, in particular on the heart, in some embodiments.

Description of Prior Art

(2) This section is intended to introduce the reader to various aspects of art that may be related to various aspects of the present disclosure, which are described and/or claimed below. This discussion is believed to be helpful in providing the reader with background information to facilitate a better understanding of the various aspects of the present disclosure. Accordingly, it should be understood that these statements are to be read in this light, and not as admissions of prior art.

(3) Endovascular procedures are being used more and more frequently to treat various cardiac and vascular surgical problems. Blocked arteries can be treated with angioplasty, endarterectomy, and/or stenting, using minimally invasive endovascular approaches. Aneurysms can be repaired by

endovascular techniques. Another use for endovascular surgery is the treatment of cardiac valvular disease. Valvuloplasties are done endovascularly and percutaneous valve replacement is becoming an established procedure. Transcatheter Aortic Heart Valve (TAVI) is a procedure involving a collapsible aortic heart valve that can be manipulated into place with minimally-invasive techniques.

(4) Cerebral embolism is a known complication of such endovascular procedures, and other cardiac surgery, cardiopulmonary bypass and catheter-based interventional cardiology, electrophysiology procedures etc. Embolic particles, may include thrombus, atheroma and lipids, plaque found in the diseased vessels and valves that is dislodged and results in embolization. Embolic particles may become dislodged by surgical or catheter manipulations and enter the bloodstream. Dislodged embolic particles can thus embolize into the brain downstream. Cerebral embolism can lead to neuropsychological deficits, stroke and even death.

(5) Prevention of cerebral embolism benefits patients and improves the outcome of these procedures. Embolic protection devices should be compatible with the endovascular procedures, and for instance not hinder passage through the aortic arch to the heart.

(6) Various embolic protection devices are known in the art.

(7) Some embolic protection devices are disclosed in WO 2012/009558 A2, or WO 2012/085916 A2, which are incorporated herein in their entirety for all purposes. However, these devices may provide iatrogenic damage to the vessels in which they are positioned, e.g. by bows or arms extending into the side vessels of the aortic arch. The bows or arms provide anchoring in the arch, but increase risk of scraping off embolic particles, in particular from around the ostia to the side vessels. The devices also have a rather high profile in the aortic arch, limiting the endovascular procedures to be performed through the arch.

(8) More advantageous low profile planar devices for embolic protection of side branch vessels of the aortic arch have for instance been disclosed in WO 2010/026240 A1 or are described in international patent application number PCT/EP2012/058384, which was published after the priority date of the present application as WO2012152761, and which all are incorporated herein in their entirety for all purposes.

(9) In WO2012009558 an umbrella shaped deflection device is disclosed having a delivery wire connected to a central hub. The device is delivered through one of the side vessels to be protected and the guide wire remains in the side vessel. The guide wire connected to the central hub may be pulled back to put the device into position. However, this leads potentially to so-called wind sucker disadvantages due to the movement of the aorta with every heart beat. Debris may collect at the edge of the umbrella and be occasionally sucked into the side vessel as the hub is locked when pulled back and does not follow the aorta movement sufficiently well. Embolic protection efficiency is thus not optimal of the devices described in WO2012009558.

(10) In US2004/0073253A1 an embolic particle capturing is disclosed, which is positioned in the aortic arch via a femoral approach. A hoop at the distal end of the device has a larger diameter than the aorta at the implantation location and presses radially outwardly against the aortic wall. The device blocks the aortic arch when in position and does not allow for index procedures to be performed in a femoral approach.

(11) In WO00/43062, a flow divider is described which compartments the aortic arch and seals the side vessel space from the latter. An embolic filter may be applied to blood perfused to the side vessel space, or filter the blood in the aortic arch in addition to the flow divider. However, the device is complicated as no blood can flow directly from the aortic arch to the side vessels and extracorporeal blood handling devices are needed.

(12) In US 2002/0133115A1 methods for capturing medical agents are provided including magnets.

(13) The devices of the state of the art may however be further improved. One issue is that blood, that may include embolic particles, may impair efficiency of the devices by bypassing across the device at the periphery thereof to the carotid arteries due to insufficient sealing at the periphery.

(14) “Sailing” of the devices in the high pressure bloodstream ejected out of the heart is another issue avoided by examples of the present disclosure. The devices shall provide a stable positioning of the deflection device in the aortic arch.

(15) Hence, notwithstanding the efforts in the prior art, there remains a need for a further improved embolic protection devices of the type that can permit endovascular procedures, in particular of the heart, while protecting the cerebral vasculature during the procedures.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(16) Accordingly, embodiments of the present disclosure preferably seek to mitigate, alleviate or eliminate one or more deficiencies, disadvantages or issues in the art, such as the above-identified, singly or in any combination by providing a device or method according to the appended patent claims for providing temporary embolic protection to a patient's aortic arch vessels during medical procedures, such as cardiac surgery and interventional cardiology and electrophysiology procedures. Embolic particles in the aortic blood flow are prevented from entering the aortic arch side branch vessels, including the carotid arteries that lead to the brain.

(17) Disclosed herein are systems and methods for embolic deflection, including systems for deployment and removal.

(18) According to one aspect of the disclosure, a collapsible, transluminally deliverable embolic protection device **200** for temporarily positioning in the aortic arch is disclosed. The device is connectable to a transluminal delivery unit **130** extending proximally from a connection point **131**, and has a frame with a periphery, and a blood permeable unit within the periphery for preventing embolic particles from passing therethrough into side vessels of the aortic arch to the brain of a patient. The frame is elongate as shown in the Figures. The device **200** may thus be substantially planar. It can in specific examples further include a length to width ratio between 8:1 and 18:7. The device may vary in length from 10 mm to 120 mm, e.g., 25 mm, 45 mm, 60 mm, 75 mm, 90 mm, or 105 mm, and width from 5 mm to 70 mm, e.g., 10 mm, 20 mm, 30 mm, 40 mm, 50 mm, or 60 mm. The length of the device **200** may in particular examples be from approximately 80 mm to 90 mm, such as 80 mm, 82 mm, 84 mm, 86 mm, 88 mm, or 90 mm, or otherwise as may be necessary to approximate a distance between an upper wall of an ascending aorta, upstream of an opening of a brachiocephalic artery, and at an upper wall of a descending aorta downstream of an opening of a left subclavian artery. The width of the device **200** may be from 10 mm to 35 mm, such as 10 mm, 15 mm, 20 mm, 25 mm, 30 mm, or 35 mm, or otherwise as may approximate an internal diameter of the aorta. The term “substantially flat” may refer to a radius of curvature of no more than 80 mm, e.g., 0 mm, 5 mm, 10 mm, 20 mm, 30 mm, 40 mm, 50 mm, 60 mm, or 70 mm. The delivery unit **130** may also be pre-shaped to press against the top aortic wall lightly, thus allowing the device to remain along the vessel wall and clear of the passage of trans-femoral accessories that may be used in therapeutic cardiovascular procedures, e.g. TAVI procedures. This preshape may include a bend, e.g., 5°, 10°, 15°, 20°, 25°, 30°, 35°, 40°, 45°, 50°, 55°, 60°, 65°, 70°, 75°, 80°, 85°, or 90°, to further facilitate device deployment flush to the aortic vessel wall.

(19) Connection point **131** can be used to connect the intra-vascular device **200** to a plunger, e.g., a plunger connected with a delivery wire disposed within a catheter. A locking mechanism with a latch may be provided at the connection point **131**. A threaded attachment may be provided at the connection point **131** to attach the delivery unit. For instance a screw at the connection point can be mated with a screw on a plunger. Connection point **131** may include in an example a release and recapture hook for connecting the device **200** with a plunger. In some examples embodiments, a hook may include a latch or wire strand that may be part of the device **200**. In other examples, the blood permeable unit, catheter, or delivery wire may end in a loop and may be threaded through a latch. When so threaded, a wire or catheter fitted with a looped end may be clicked into a hook and may securely push the device into place or pull the device out of position from the aorta. In some examples, the hook may end in a ball-tip so that strands from the blood permeable unit do not fray or unravel or scratch the vessel wall or the inner tube of a catheter. In other embodiments, a clasp at

an end of the device may be pressed into or onto a clasp at, for example, an end of a catheter or delivery wire, and the two clasps may be joined by such pressing.

(20) In still other example, the device **200** may be adapted for use with other embolic protection devices, e.g., those described in U.S. Pat. Nos. 8,062,324 and 7,232,453, each of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

(21) In some embodiments, the device may be rotated clockwise or counter-clockwise respectively.

(22) The device further includes at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, which is not a delivery shaft or guide wire of the device. The tissue apposition sustaining unit is provided for application of a force offset to the connection point at the device. The force may be called a stabilization force as the force contributes to a secure positioning of the embolic protection device in the aortic arch. Offset to the connection point may for instance be at the periphery. It may also be adjacent the periphery. It may also be centrally of the blood permeable unit within the periphery. The force is applied or directed towards an inner wall of the aortic arch when the device is positioned in the aortic arch. In this manner tissue apposition of the periphery to an inner wall of the aortic arch is supported by the force. For instance, a tractive force such applied may pull a periphery of the device against the inner wall. The tractive force may be applied against a delivery catheter or the like and lifts the embolic protection device against the aortic wall, in a direction away from the heart, preferably a coronal direction (“upwards”/toward the patient's neck or head). The (stabilization) force supports locking the device in place upon implantation.

(23) The embolic protection device can thus be reliably placed across the apex of the aorta in order to prevent emboli from flowing into the carotid arteries. The inventive solution is not iatrogenic, as it prevents creation of debris from e.g. ostia of side vessels. Iatrogenic relates to an adverse condition in a patient resulting from treatment by a physician or surgeon. Arms, anchors, delivery shafts, bows, etc. of inferior embolic protection devices, for instance extending into the side vessels, risking scraping off of plaque from the inner vessel wall or ostia, are not needed and can be avoided thanks to the present disclosure.

(24) Embolic particles, are efficiently prevented from bypassing across the device at the periphery thereof to the carotid arteries thanks to improved sealing at the periphery. “Sailing” of the devices in the high pressure bloodstream ejected out of the heart avoided. A stable positioning of the deflection device in the aortic arch is provided.

(25) The embolic protection device may preferably be a deflector for deflecting embolic particles. Alternatively, or in addition, it may be a filter for catching embolic particles.

(26) The device may in examples be deliverable via a side channel catheter, e.g. via a femoral approach. Such as side channel catheter is described in PCT/EP2012/0058384, which was published after the priority date of the present application as WO2012152761, and which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes. The catheter may further be improved by multiple side channels, one for the embolic protection device. Tethers may run in the same channel or other channels of the catheter. A pigtail catheter may be provided in such an auxiliary side channel. The pigtail catheter may be used to further stabilize the catheter against the annulus of the aortic valve and/or inner wall of the aortic arch, such as described in WO 2012/094195 A1, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes, see in particular FIGS. 10A and 10B of WO 2012/094195 A1 as well as related description passages in WO 2012/094195 A1.

(27) The device may in examples be deliverable via a side vessel, such as described in WO 2010/026240 A1.

(28) The device may in examples be deliverable via the aorta, e.g. in a direct aorta approach, such as described in concurrently filed US application of the same applicant with the title “METHOD FOR DELIVERY OF AN EMBOLIC PROTECTION UNIT” and it's priority application with application No. 61/726,540 filed 14 Nov. 2012. Both applications are herein incorporated herein by reference in their entirety for all purposes.

(29) The aforementioned force, also called stabilization force, may include or be a tractive force. The apposition sustaining/supporting unit may then be an active traction unit that for instance has at least one operable tether **300** distally connected at the location offset the connection point **131**. The distal connection location **310** of the traction unit or tether may be located at the frame **133**, periphery **180** and/or blood permeable unit **132**, of the embolic protection device **200** for providing the tractive force to the device. The tether **300** has one or more distal end(s). The distal end is for instance connected to the periphery **180** of the embolic protection device **200**. The tether's **300** distal end(s) may be connected to the blood permeable unit **132**, such as a filter or deflector membrane. The membrane may be moved by the traction, e.g. if the membrane is flexible and/or elastic. Thus the traction may lift the membrane.

(30) Tether(s), or more precisely, tetherline(s) are provided to control a sealing degree of the periphery. Tether(s) are provided for direction of apposition towards aortic tissue/cerebral arteries. The tether may provide active traction by a pull action on the tether communicated to the embolic protection device to which it is distally connected. The traction force may be different than a pulling force of a delivery device of the embolic protection device, thus advantageously avoiding a windsucker effect as the forces may be chosen so that the periphery of the device follows the aortic arch movement to a larger degree than its attached delivery device.

(31) The tether is movable relative the delivery unit **130**. The delivery unit **130** provides in these examples a counter point for being able to apply the stabilization force, e.g. like a Bowden cable principle. Alternatively, or in addition, for instance a collection device in form of a conical filter co-axially arranged around the delivery device in use anchored in the side vessel may provide a counter point for being able to provide the needed stabilization force to the embolic protection device. In this manner, the device **200** is positionable in the aortic arch so that the delivery device may be locked in a “delivered” position, e.g. at its proximal end at or outside a port of an introducer. The tether may then still be movable and improve sealing as described herein.

(32) In any of the devices of the invention, the delivery unit **130** may also include a preformed bend, such as shown in FIG. 1. The preformed bend can be between 5° and 90°. In some aspects, the device **100** also includes a filter (not shown), e.g. expandable from the exterior of the catheter **160**, proximal to the transluminally deliverable embolic protection device **200** for temporarily positioning in the aortic arch, and also, e.g., proximal to the preformed bend. The filter can be sized to filter a side branch blood vessel. A delivery unit **130**, such as a central member at the transluminally deliverable embolic protection device **200**, can thus pass through the second filter. The filter can have the capability of preventing particles from passing from the aortic arch downstream the side vessel. The filter may be expandable for engagement into the vessel wall of the side vessel. It may provide for a fix point allowing the application of the traction force while preventing disadvantages related to the windsucker effect. The filter may be conical in shape with a catheter and/or delivery wire passing through the apex of the filter. The filter may also be substantially flat with the catheter and/or delivery wire passing through any point within the filter so long as the catheter and/or delivery wire is connected to the filter, e.g., at all points along the catheter's or delivery wire's outer perimeter. The width of the widest portion of the filter may be pre-sized and pre-formed to accommodate particular subclavian arterial anatomy, e.g., 2, 4, 6, or 8 mm in width. Other shapes may be used.

(33) Tether(s) may be multifilament(s) tether(s), which provides for a particularly flexible solution advantageous for narrow lumen navigation.

(34) A tether may extend straight across the blood permeable unit to the forward end of the device. Thus the middle line may be pulled up and the periphery is tensioned against the inner wall. The tether provides for a lifting force to the forward end. In case the tether is guided at the middle line, e.g. threaded through eyelets, it may provide a progressive lifting force distributed along the device, which allows for particular effective sealing and/or stabilization at the periphery.

(35) The at least one tether may be longitudinally elastic, i.e. it is longitudinally stretchable and

resiliently return to a non-stretched longitudinal extension. The tether may be elastic along its entire length. The tether may include one or more elastic portions or elastic elements. The elastic portion may be a helical wound portion of the tether acting as a spring. The elastic portion may be a tubular braid of a double helically wound strands. The elastic portion may be made of an elastic material, preferably biocompatible, like rubber. In this manner the tractive force is variable. This may be advantageous for preventing rupture of the tether line as a non-linear extension may be “felt” by an operator. This variable traction force may also be advantageous if the tether is tension, applying a desired traction for improving sealing of the embolic protection device. The tether may be locked at its proximal end in this position, e.g. extending out of an introducer port. The elasticity may provide for compensating physiological movements of the aortic arch relative a proximal end of the device and/or tether while maintaining the tissue apposition. Issues related to the afore described windsucker effect are avoided. The applied force is provided within a certain range suitable to maintain the improved peripheral sealing while the aortic arch moves due to the beating heart and blood pulse waves.

(36) The blood permeable unit may have at least one guiding unit, such as an eyelet, a tubular bent element, a roller, etc. The guiding unit may receive the tether proximally its distal end where it is attached to the device, such as at the blood permeable unit, flange, or periphery. The guiding units, such as eyelet(s) etc. provide for locally controllable apposition at the device. The traction force may be distributed to different areas of the device.

(37) The device may have an attachment point where a distal end of the tether is connected to the device and a tractive force is transmissible via the attachment point to the device towards the periphery. Optionally a radiopaque one or more fiducial markers may be provided at the device. A fiducial marker may be provided at the attachment point. Fiducial markers provide for advantageous X-ray visibility and navigation, position feedback and control of the device.

(38) In some examples, the tether is proximally extending through an ostium into a selected side vessel such that the tractive force centers the device in relation to the ostium. When pulling the tetherline, it pulls the device at its periphery against the inner wall of the aorta for locking the device in place. In this manner the device is self aligning in relation to the ostium of the selected side vessel thanks to the tether. The skilled person may provide suitable guiding units for the tether when reading this disclosure to obtain this function.

(39) The device may include multiple tethers distally attached along the periphery. Alternatively, or in addition, a single proximal tetherline may separate distally into a plurality of (sub)tetherlines. For instance, a tether may be branched in the form of a Y. A single tether to be operated proximally may then distribute a tractive force distally via its two distal end points to the embolic protection device. An example with a plurality of endpoints is shown in FIG. 8. Multiple tethers may be used or combined with tethers having multiple distal ends. The multiple tethers may be collected proximally at the device, e.g. at a base thereof. In this manner, the device provides for a progressive force that is evenly distributed along the periphery of the device. The device may in this manner advantageously adapt to the inner shape of the aortic arch. The adaptation may even more enhanced by providing longitudinally elastic portions at the tether(s). For instance, the branched (sub)tetherlines may be provided of elastic material, while the main line is substantially non-elastic, but flexible.

(40) In some examples, the device may have at least one rib extending between different, preferably opposite, joints at the periphery, wherein the tether is distally attached at the rib. The tether may thus apply a tractive force to the rib(s), which in turn transfers the force to the periphery of the device towards the aortic inner wall tissue. The rib may be a beam or yoke. It may be arranged longitudinal or transversal in relation to the expanded device's longitudinal axis. There may be a plurality of such ribs in a device. Devices having multiple petals or wings may have one or more ribs on one or more of the petals or wings to obtain a favourable force distribution. The rib may be capable of providing structural support to the device. The term “provide structural support”

refers to the property contributing to shape and stiffness of the device. The stiffness of the intra-vascular device **200** will be determined by the stiffness of the blood permeable unit, the periphery, and/or radiating supporting members. For example, the device **200** can be stiffened by the inclusion of heavier gauge wire or by the inclusion of stiffer central member, yoke, or radiating supporting members. Furthermore, multiple wires of a certain gauge can be wound together to increase the stiffness of the device, e.g., the device can include 2, 3, 4, 5, or more wires to increase the stiffness of the intra-vascular device **200**.

(41) For instance a petal or wing of the device may be arranged upstream in relation to the aortic blood flow. Alternatively, or in addition, the device may have a petal or wing of the device may be arranged downstream in relation to the aortic blood flow. One or more, or each of the petals or wings may have tissue apposition sustaining unit(s), like tethers, pushers, springs as described herein. It may be sufficient to provide petals or wings arranged upstream in relation to the aortic blood flow with tissue apposition sustaining unit(s). Petals or wings arranged downstream may be sufficiently pushed against the aortic inner wall tissue by the pulsatile blood flow in the aorta passing along the blood permeable unit of the device. However, having tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) at petals or wings arranged in downstream direction from a connection point may advantageously be supported by such tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) during pressure changes in the aorta. The aortic pressure is lower during the diastolic phases and may tend to be more leaky than during systolic phases. The tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) may be dimensioned to be sufficient supportive during diastole, and thus be more advantageous (smaller, less mass) for insertion into the body than being dimensioned for systolic pressure support.

(42) The tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) may limit movement of the blood permeable unit caused by the pulsatile blood flow. The abovementioned “sailing” of the device is this limited or avoided by the tissue apposition units(s). For instance having a rib may provide for this limited movement range. The rib and/or tether limit movement of the blood permeable unit. Having connected a tether to the device may provide then for a progressive traction force and particularly improved sealing as forces on the periphery caused by pulsatile pressure changes are evenly distributed during heartbeat's pulsatile flows.

(43) The rib may be a yoke, such as extending proximally above the blood permeable unit. “Above” means on the filtered side of the unit downstream the blood flow passing the unit. “Below” means consequently in that context the opposite side. The yoke may preferably extend in a longitudinal direction of at least a portion of the device. The distal tether end(s) may be directly attached to the rib. The distal tether end(s) may be guided by guiding units(s) at the rib to the to periphery, providing an advantageous distribution of tractive force. An “above” positioned rib may at the same time limit movement of the blood permeable unit, thus avoiding contact with tissue, e.g. ostia and avoids generation of debris by such avoided contact. Device of examples of the present disclosure can include additional rib members that are located above and/or below a selectively permeable unit **132**.

(44) The device may include multiple tethers, or a single tether splitting distally into multiple strands. In an example two tethers or strands are distally attached to the periphery in a Y-shape from a base of the device.

(45) The device may include at least one eyelet, wherein one or more of the tethers are threaded through at least one eyelet. An eyelet may preferably be provided at a pivot point and/or at a base of the device. Contact of the tether with tissue, e.g. ostia is thus avoided thanks to the eyelets and generation of debris is avoided by preventing contact of the tether with tissue when tensioned.

(46) The blood permeable unit may be flexible. It is for example a flat (substantially planar) membrane with defined porosity or holes. A tether may be distally attached to the membrane. A traction force thus applied may raise the membrane out of a plane of the membrane, such that for instance to a volcano shape, including the attachment location of the tether to the membrane at the to thereof. The volcano shape may be advantageously increasing the efficiency of the device. The

top of the volcano shape may be arranged to extend into an ostium, into a portion of a side vessel. Trapping of particles may thus be provided by the interior funnel shape of the volcano into which blood flows. Increased filter efficiency will be the result.

(47) The traction unit may alternatively or additionally include a passive traction unit. The passive traction unit is not operated by an operator, but provides automatically for the stabilization force and improved peripheral sealing. The passive traction unit may be a spring. It may have a shape memory element for instance activated by body temperature, such as a portion of the frame, for providing the tractive force relative a delivery portion or device. For instance the device may include “winglets” extending from the periphery of the device which have a shape memory.

Another example is shape memory springs that are activated to tension tethers, e.g. from a base of the device. A portion of a tether may be provided as a shape memory portion. Such tether may be delivered in an elongate shape and then change to a memory induced shape, shortening the tether to provide the tensile force. The memory induced shape may be a helical coil shape additionally allowing for elasticity of the memory activated tether, particularly advantageous for pressure and/or movement compensations.

(48) The device may have a flange unit extending radially outward from the periphery of the device, e.g. from the frame. The flange unit may be angled in relation to a plane of the blood permeable unit for a pre-tension against which the tractive force is provided. The flange unit may provide for further improved sealing as sealing is supported by the blood pressure in the aorta. The flange unit may be made of a fabric. The fabric may be woven. The fabric may be woven from PTFE threads providing for advantageous sealing and biocompatibility. The fabric may be arranged as a collar around the frame of the device. The collar may extend in a direction opposite to a filter membrane attached to the frame. The flange unit provides for avoiding recesses at the periphery of the device towards the inner wall tissue. This is particularly advantageous as embolic particles may collect in such recesses. These collected particles may then be flushed into the side vessels when the device is removed. Avoiding particles collecting at the periphery reduces this potential issue.

(49) The tissue apposition sustaining unit may include a pushing unit, and the force includes a pushing force, against the frame, periphery and/or blood permeable unit. The pushing unit provides the pushing force and presses the periphery to the inner wall.

(50) The tissue apposition sustaining unit may include a magnetic element and the force includes a magnetic force.

(51) According to another aspect of the disclosure, a method of positioning an embolic protection device, such as a deflector and/or filter, in the aortic arch, is disclosed. The method includes transluminally delivering the embolic protection device to the aortic arch, the device connected to a transluminal delivery unit **130** extending proximally from a connection point **131** of the device. Further the method includes positioning the device in the aortic arch. The positioning includes expanding a frame of the device and flattening a blood permeable unit in the aortic arch, and bringing a periphery of the device in apposition with an inner wall of the aortic arch to cover ostia of side vessels at least includes the carotid arteries. Thus positioned, the device is preventing embolic particles from passing therethrough into side vessels of the aorta to the brain of a patient. Moreover, the method includes applying a force by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of the device, to the device. The force is applied offset to the connection point at the device, such as at the periphery. The force is directed towards an inner wall of the aortic arch when the device is positioned in the aortic arch. In this manner tissue apposition of the periphery to an inner wall of the aortic arch is supported by the force.

(52) This method is less iatrogenic than known methods. It provides for improved sealing of the periphery of an embolic protection device. It further prevents creation of debris from an ostium in the aortic arch.

(53) The supported apposition is improving apposition of the periphery to the inner wall of the aortic arch, such that the improved apposition provides for improved sealing of the periphery

against the inner wall.

(54) The force may be applied in a substantially proximal direction relative the device for the improved sealing.

(55) Applying the force may include applying a tractive force by a traction unit. The tractive force may include pulling a periphery of the device against the inner wall for locking the device in place in the aortic arch. The tractive force may be applied by at least one tether distally connected to the frame, periphery and/or blood permeable unit for providing the tractive force.

(56) The device may be delivered to the aortic arch via one of the side vessels, such as the brachiocephalic artery from the right subclavian artery, the left carotid artery, or the left subclavian artery. It may be delivered to the aortic arch via the descending aorta such as in a femoral approach, e.g. in a side channel of a main catheter. It may be delivered to the aortic arch through the wall of the ascending aorta, which is an approach called “direct aorta” approach.

(57) According to another aspect of the disclosure, a method of preventing emboli flowing in the aortic arch from entering side branch vessels thereof, is provided. The method includes advancing an embolic protection to the aortic arch; and manipulating the protection device such that it covers the ostia of each of the side branch vessels. The method further includes applying a force to the protection device for improving sealing of the device at a periphery thereof. Application of the force includes applying a force offset to a connection point at the device by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of the device. In this manner the protection device permits blood flow from the aortic arch into each of the side branch vessels, but prevents emboli from entering the first and second side branch vessels without obstructing the lumen of the aortic arch.

(58) According to a further aspect of the disclosure, a method for limiting the flow of emboli into the carotid arteries from the aorta, is provided. The method includes delivering an embolic protection device to the aortic arch to extend between the ascending aorta and the descending aorta to position the embolic protection device or components thereof into the aortic arch to prevent embolic debris to enter the carotid arteries. Further, it includes proximally tensioning at least one tether member distally connected to the embolic protection device, thus controlling a degree of apposition and fluid sealing of the embolic protection device against the inner vessel wall of the aortic arch.

(59) According to a still further aspect of the disclosure, a method for performing an endovascular procedure on a heart, is disclosed. The method includes delivering an embolic protection device to the aortic arch through one of the following vessels: the brachiocephalic artery from the right subclavian artery, the left carotid artery, the left subclavian artery, or the descending aorta such as in a femoral approach; or through the wall of the ascending aorta. It includes positioning the embolic protection device into the aortic arch to prevent embolic debris to enter the carotid arteries. The method includes applying a force to the protection device for improving sealing of the device at a periphery thereof, includes applying a force offset to a connection point at the device by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of the device. In this manner, the method allows for controlling a degree of apposition and fluid sealing of the embolic protection device against the inner vessel wall of the aortic arch by the applied force. Moreover, the method includes delivering a first catheter through the descending aorta, the left subclavian artery or the aortic vessel wall at the aortic arch to the heart to effect at least a step related to the endovascular procedure on the heart.

(60) The step of applying the force may includes proximally tensioning at least one tether member distally connected to the embolic protection device.

(61) The step of delivering the embolic protection device may be made transluminally, and delivering the first catheter may be performed after the delivering the embolic protection device.

(62) Delivering the first catheter may include placing a balloon mounted on the first catheter with expanding the balloon in the ascending aortic arch to lock a distal end of the first catheter in place.

The balloon may have a donut shape having a filter between the catheter and the inner ring of the donut shape.

(63) The embolic protection device used in the method may extend from a distal end of a second catheter or separate channel of the first catheter, such that the position of the embolic protection device can be independently adjusted from the position of the first catheter.

(64) Delivering a first catheter may be performed concurrently with delivering the embolic protection device via a separate channel of the first catheter, independent of the endovascular procedure.

(65) The endovascular procedure on the heart may include at least a step related to removal of a heart valve, the placement of a prosthetic heart valve, or repair of a heart valve. The embolic protection device may be removed from the aortic arch following performance of the endovascular procedure.

(66) Further embodiments of the disclosure are defined in the dependent claims, wherein features for the second and subsequent aspects of the invention are as for the first aspect *mutatis mutandis*.

(67) Some examples of the disclosure provide for a low profile of the embolic protection device within the aorta which allows sheaths, catheters, or wires used in endovascular procedures on the heart to pass thanks to the tether.

(68) Some examples of the disclosure also provide for avoiding of anchors, arms, bows extending from the device etc. that may cause tissue damage/cause debris to be scraped off and washed away.

(69) Some examples of the disclosure avoid additional portions of the embolic protection device being in tissue contact with the aorta's or side vessels' inner wall, in particular adjacent or in the vicinity of ostia in the aortic arch.

(70) The term "sustain" as used herein means one of support, aid, assist, keep up, uphold or the like. Sustaining a tissue apposition of a device according to the present disclosure may be provided by a push force or a pull force supporting, aiding or assisting apposition, depending on the specific embodiment.

(71) The term "tether" as used herein shall not be confused with a safety tether, which is a simple safety line for allowing retrieval of an embolic protection device if needed. A tether as used herein is a line allowing controlled tensioning of an entire embolic protection device or selected portions thereof. Traction is applied proximally to the tether for the providing the tensioning of the device to an inner vessel. The tether is distally connected or attached to the embolic protection device such that the traction supports anchoring of the device against the inner vessel wall. In this manner a fluid flow at the periphery of the device is controllable and can be totally stopped by the degree of traction on the tether such that blood only passes a blood permeable unit of the device. As used herein, the term "tether" or "strand" refers to any elongated structure, e.g., cords, fibers, yarns, filaments, cables, and threads, fabricated from any non-degradable material, e.g., polycarbonate, polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE), polyvinylidene fluoride, (PVDF), polypropylene, porous urethane, Nitinol, fluoropolymers (Teflon®), cobalt chromium alloys (CoCr), and para-aramid (Kevlar®), or textile, e.g., nylon, polyester (Dacron®), or silk.

(72) The device including the inventive improvement of embodiments, includes a collapsible embolic protection device devised for temporary transvascular delivery to an aortic arch of a patient, the device having a protection unit including a selectively permeable material or unit adapted to prevent embolic material from passage with a blood flow into a plurality of aortic side branch vessels at the aortic arch, wherein the protection unit is permanently or releasably (for assembly prior to introduction into the body) attached to a transvascular delivery unit at a connection point or region, or an attachment point, provided at the selectively permeable unit, and a first support member for the protection unit that is at least partly arranged at a periphery of the selectively permeable unit. In an expanded state of the device, the connection point is enclosed by the first support member or integral therewith, wherein the transvascular delivery unit is connected off-center to the protection unit at the connection point. In some embodiments, the connection point

or region, or attachment point, is enclosed by the first support member.

(73) The connection point may be provided at the selectively permeable unit or at the first support member.

(74) The connection point may be provided on a surface of the selectively permeable unit devised to be oriented towards the aortic side branch vessels from inside the aortic arch and at a distance from the ostia regions when the protection unit is positioned in the aortic arch.

(75) In some embodiments, the selectively permeable unit includes a first portion devised to extend in a first direction towards a descending aorta of the aortic arch from the connection point, and a second portion devised to extend in a second direction, opposite to the first direction, towards an ascending aorta of the aortic arch from the connection point, when the protection unit is positioned in the aortic arch, in the expanded state.

(76) In some embodiments, the selectively permeable unit is arranged to asymmetrically extend from the connection point in a first direction towards a descending aorta of the aortic arch and in a second direction towards an ascending aorta of the aortic arch, when the protection unit is positioned in the aortic arch, in the expanded state.

(77) The term “collapsible” used in the context of the present application means that a dimension of a device is reducible to a lesser dimension such that it is arrangeable in a tubular delivery unit, such as a catheter. A collapsible unit is expandable when released or pushed out of the delivery unit. Expandable includes self expandable, e.g. by a shape memory effect and/or resilient elasticity. A collapsible unit is the re-collapsible for withdrawal into the delivery unit and out of the patient.

(78) It should be emphasized that the term “including/having” when used in this disclosure is taken to specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps or components but does not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, components or groups thereof.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) These and other aspects, features and advantages of which embodiments of the invention are capable of will be apparent and elucidated from the following description of embodiments of the present disclosure, reference being made to the accompanying drawings, in which

(2) FIG. 1 is a schematic illustration of a protective device attached to a transvascular delivery unit in its expanded configuration deployed in an aortic arch, the device including a tether;

(3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view illustrating an embolic protection device with a tether;

(4) FIG. 3 is a planar view from above illustrating an embolic protection device with a tether;

(5) FIG. 4 is a schematic illustration showing an embolic protection device with a tether in a catheter, outside a catheter, and delivered in an aortic arch;

(6) FIG. 5 is a perspective view showing the device of FIG. 4 enlarged and in more detail;

(7) FIG. 6 is a schematic illustration showing an embolic protection device with a tether in a catheter, outside a catheter, and delivered in an aortic arch;

(8) FIG. 7 is a perspective view showing the device of FIG. 6 enlarged and in more detail;

(9) FIG. 8 is a planar view from above illustrating an embolic protection device with multiple tethers

(10) FIGS. 9A and 9B are schematic views illustrating a catheter with a side channel and an embolic protection device with a tether, delivered via a side vessel;

(11) FIG. 10 is a schematic view illustrating a catheter delivered via a femoral approach with a side channel and an embolic protection device with a tether;

(12) FIG. 11 is schematic view illustrating a catheter with a side channel and an embolic protection device with a hinge and a tether, delivered via a side vessel;

(13) FIG. 12 is a schematic view illustrating a catheter delivered via a femoral approach with a side

channel and an embolic protection device with multiple tethers;

(14) FIG. 13 is schematic view illustrating a catheter with a side channel and an embolic protection device with a pushing unit, delivered via a femoral approach;

(15) FIG. 14 is a schematic view illustrating an embolic protection device with a flange unit **400**;

(16) FIG. 15 is a flowchart illustrating a method **600**.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(17) Specific examples will now be described with reference to the accompanying drawings. This invention may, however, be embodied in many different forms and should not be construed as limited to the embodiments set forth herein; rather, these embodiments are provided so that this disclosure will be thorough and complete, and will fully convey the scope of the invention to those skilled in the art. The terminology used in the detailed description of the embodiments illustrated in the accompanying drawings is not intended to be limiting of the invention. In the drawings, like numbers refer to like elements.

(18) FIG. 1 shows a schematic illustration of an aortic arch **100** and a plurality of side branch vessels, including a third side branch vessel **116**, a second side branch vessel **118**, and a first side branch vessel **120**. The aortic valve **6** is illustrated in some of the Figs. Normally, three branches of the aorta split off from the trunk of the aortic arch **100** in three separate ostia. The third side branch vessel **116** is called the brachiocephalic artery, the second side branch vessel **118** is called the left common carotid artery, and the first side branch vessel **120** is called the left subclavian artery. The side branch vessels usually split from the aortic arch as three separate arterial trunks, arising from different positions on the aortic arch **100**. The brachiocephalic artery **116** is the largest diameter branch of the aortic arch and normally gives rise to a bifurcation from which extend the right subclavian artery **115**, leading blood e.g. to the right arm, and the right common carotid artery **117** conveying arterial blood towards the neck and head. The left common carotid artery **118** usually branches directly from the aortic arch **100**. The common carotid arteries **117**, **118** then branch into the external and internal carotid arteries that supply blood to the neck and head regions. The left and right subclavian arteries **120**, **115** ultimately provide the arterial path for blood destined for the vertebral arteries, the internal thoracic arteries, and other vessels that provide oxygenated blood to the thoracic wall, spinal cord, and parts of the upper arm, neck, meninges, and the brain.

(19) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of an embolic protection device having a support member **133** of wire. Two branches of the wire cross each other at a crossing **196** towards the delivery unit **130**. The wires are joined at attachment point **131**, e.g. by clamping, welding, gluing.

(20) The collapsible embolic protection device **200** is provided that is devised for temporary transvascular delivery to an aortic arch **100** of a patient, and temporary positioning in or across the aortic arch **100**. Several examples of the device are described below. The devices have a collapsible protection unit **140** for preventing embolic material **150** from entering into at least one of the side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** of the aortic arch **100** in an expanded state thereof when suitably positioned in the aortic arch **100**. Preferably at least the left and right carotid arteries **118**, **117** are protected from embolic material **150** present in the aortic arch **100**. All of the side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** may be covered.

(21) The example of the embolic protection device **200** further includes a first support member **133** for the protection unit **140** that is at least partly arranged at a periphery **180** of the selectively permeable unit **132**. The selectively permeable unit **132** is permeable for blood but impermeable for embolic material. The selectively permeable unit **132** is connected or attached to the first support member **133** by in a suitable manner. Alternatively, the selectively permeable unit **132** may be integral with the first support member **133**.

(22) The protection unit **140** includes a selectively permeable material or unit **132** adapted to selectively prevent embolic material **150** from passage with a blood flow (symbolic arrows in FIG. 1) into the plurality of aortic side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** at the aortic arch **100**. The blood flow into the side branch vessels is substantially not hindered when passing the embolic protective

device **200**. The protection unit **140** is permanently connected to or attached to a transvascular delivery unit **130** at a connection point or region, or an attachment point **131** provided at the selectively permeable unit **132**. The connection point or region may for instance be provided when the protection unit is integral with a support element thereof, and not attached thereto, but transiting from the transvascular delivery unit **130** to the protection unit **140**, e.g. at a support member of the protection unit **140**.

(23) Depending on the characteristics of the selectively permeable unit **132**, embolic material may be temporary trapped in the selectively permeable unit **132**. The selectively permeable unit **132** may include a filter material. Alternatively, or in addition, the selectively permeable unit **132** may include or be made of a porous material. In any example of the devices of the disclosure, the selectively permeable unit **132** material can include braided, woven, or clustered material. In certain aspects, the selectively permeable unit **132** material can include laminated mesh. For example, the mesh can include polymeric film, e.g., perforated polymeric film. Alternatively, or in addition, the selectively permeable unit **132** may have characteristics that the embolic material glides or slides along a surface thereof oriented away from the ostia, thus deflecting embolic debris past the side branch vessels. In any examples of the devices of the disclosure, the protection unit **140** and/or the permeable unit **132** can include Drawn Filled Tubing, e.g., including an outer layer of Nitinol and/or a core that includes tantalum and/or platinum.

(24) The first support member **133** is shaped to apposition to tissue of a vessel wall portion of the aortic arch **100**. The first support member **133** is formed to encircle the plurality of ostia of the aortic side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** inside the aortic arch **100**, and at a distance to the ostia. In this manner the selectively permeable unit **132** is arranged to separate a first fluid volume of the aortic side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** from a second fluid volume in the aortic arch **100** when the protection unit **140** is positioned in the aortic arch **100**, as illustrated in FIG. 1. A blood flow occurs from the second fluid volume in the aortic arch **100** to the first fluid volume of the aortic side branch through the selectively permeable unit **132** preventing embolic particles of selected size to pass.

(25) The embolic protection device is usually delivered transvascularely through a catheter **160** to the aortic arch. Delivery may be made through different vessels, other than those specifically illustrated as an example in the Figs.

(26) According to one aspect of the disclosure, the collapsible, transluminally deliverable embolic protection device **200** for temporarily positioning in the aortic arch is connectable or fixedly connected to the transluminal delivery unit **130** extending proximally from a connection point **131**. The device **200** has the first support member in form of a frame with the periphery **180**, and the blood permeable unit **132** within the periphery **180** for preventing embolic particles **150** from passing therethrough into side vessels of the aortic arch **100** to the brain of a patient. The device further includes at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, which is not a delivery shaft of the device. The tissue apposition sustaining unit is provided for application of a force offset to the connection point at the device.

(27) A tissue apposition sustaining unit provides for supporting a tissue apposition of the device **200** to the inner wall of the aortic arch.

(28) Offset to the connection point may for instance be at the periphery **180**. It may also be adjacent the periphery **180**. It may also be centrally of the blood permeable unit **132** within the periphery **180**.

(29) The force, also called stabilization force, is applied or directed towards an inner wall of the aortic arch **100** when the device is positioned in the aortic arch. The force is in an example illustrated in the Figs. by the arrow **301**.

(30) In this manner tissue apposition of the periphery **180** to an inner wall of the aortic arch **100** is supported by the force as illustrated by arrow **301**. The aortic arch provides a counterforce as it has limited flexibility and elasticity. This equilibrium of force and counterforce entrails improved

sealing of the periphery **180**. It may also provide for limited motion of the aortic arch at the embolic protection device as the device is locked more or less into place. However, movement of the aortic arch may still be present and compensated as described herein, for instance to prevent the so-called windsucker effect disadvantages.

(31) For instance, a tractive force such applied may pull a periphery of the device against the inner wall. The force supports the aforementioned locking the device in place upon implantation.

(32) The embolic protection device **200** can thus be reliably placed across the apex of the aorta in order to prevent emboli from flowing into the carotid arteries. The inventive solution is not iatrogenic, as it prevents creation of debris from e.g. ostia of side vessels. Iatrogenic relates to an adverse condition in a patient resulting from treatment by a physician or surgeon. Arms, anchors, delivery shafts, bows, etc. of inferior embolic protection devices, for instance extending into the side vessels, risking scraping off of plaque from the inner vessel wall or ostia, are not needed and can be avoided thanks to the present disclosure.

(33) The embolic protection device **200** may be a deflector for deflecting embolic particles. Alternatively, or in addition, it may in examples be a filter for catching embolic particles.

(34) The device may in examples be deliverable via a side channel **7** of a catheter **2**, e.g. via a femoral approach. Such as side channel catheter **2** is described in PCT/EP2012/0058384, which was published after the priority date of the present application as WO2012152761, and which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes. The catheter may further be improved by multiple side channels, wherein one side channel **7** is provided for conveying the embolic protection device **200** to the aortic arch **100**. Tethers **300** may run in the same channel or other channels of the catheter as the embolic protection device **200** and delivery unit **130**. A pigtail catheter may be provided in such an auxiliary side channel. The pigtail catheter may be used to further stabilize the catheter in a femoral delivery approach, supporting the catheter **2** against the annulus of the aortic valve and inner wall of the aortic arch, such as described in WO 2012/094195 A1, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety for all purposes, see in particular FIGS. 10A and 10B of WO 2012/094195 A1 as well as related description passages in WO 2012/094195 A1.

(35) The device **200** may in examples be deliverable via a side vessel, such as described in WO 2010/026240 A1.

(36) The device may in examples be deliverable through the wall of the aorta **100**, e.g. in a so called direct aorta approach.

(37) The aforementioned force **301** may include or be a tractive force depending on the type of apposition supporting unit. The apposition sustaining/supporting unit may then be an active traction unit that has for instance at least one operable tether **300** distally connected at the location offset the connection point. The distal connection location of the tether may be located at the frame, periphery and/or blood permeable unit, of the embolic protection device for providing the tractive force. The tether has one or more distal end(s). The distal end is for instance connected to the periphery of the embolic protection device. The tether's distal end(s) may be connected to the blood permeable unit, such as a filter or deflector membrane. The membrane may be moved by the traction, e.g. if the membrane is flexible and/or elastic.

(38) Tether(s), or more precisely, tetherline(s) are provided to control a sealing degree of the periphery. Tether(s) are provided for direction of apposition towards aortic tissue/cerebral arteries. The tether may provide active traction by a pull action on the tether communicated to the embolic protection device to which it is distally connected.

(39) The tether may be arranged longitudinally movable relative the delivery unit **130**. In this manner, the device **200** is positionable in the aortic arch so that the delivery device may be locked in a "delivered" position, by the delivery unit **130**, e.g. at its proximal end at or outside a port of an introducer. The tether **300** may then still be movable and improve sealing as described herein.

(40) Tether(s) **300** may be multifilament(s), which provides for a particularly flexible solution

advantageous for narrow lumen navigation.

(41) A tether **300** may extend straight across the blood permeable unit to the forward end of the device. Thus the middle line may be pulled up and the periphery is tensioned against the inner wall. The tether provides for a lifting force to the forward end. In case the tether is guided at the middle line, e.g. threaded through eyelets, it may provide a progressive lifting force distributed along the device. See for instance FIGS. **2**, **6**, **7** and **8**.

(42) The at least one tether **300** may be longitudinally elastic, i.e. it is longitudinally stretchable and resiliently return to a non-stretched longitudinal extension. The tether may be elastic along its entire length. The tether may include one or more elastic portions or elastic elements. The elastic portion may be a helical wound portion of the tether acting as a spring. The elastic portion may be a tubular braid of a double helically wound strands. The elastic portion may be made of an elastic material, preferably biocompatible, like rubber. In this manner the tractive force is variable. This may be advantageous for preventing rupture of the tether line as a non-linear extension may be “felt” by an operator. This variable traction force may also be advantageous if the tether is tension, applying a desired traction for improving sealing of the embolic protection device. The tether may be locked at its proximal end in this position, e.g. extending out of an introducer port. The elasticity may provide for compensating physiological movements of the aortic arch relative a proximal end of the device and/or tether while maintaining the tissue apposition. The applied force is provided within a certain range suitable to maintain the improved peripheral sealing while the aortic arch moves due to the beating heart and blood pulse waves.

(43) The blood permeable unit **132** may have at least one guiding unit **320**, such as an eyelet, a tubular bent element, a roller, an open pocket fabric portion, etc. The guiding unit may receive the tether proximally its distal end where it is attached to the device, such as at the blood permeable unit, flange, or periphery. The guiding units, such as eyelet(s) etc. provide for locally controllable apposition at the device. The traction force may be distributed to different areas of the device.

(44) The device may have an attachment point where a distal end of the tether is connected to the device and a tractive force is transmissible via the attachment point to the device towards the periphery. Optionally one or more radiopaque fiducial markers may be provided at the device. A fiducial marker may be provided at the attachment point. Such radiopaque elements can be affixed to, or incorporated into the intra-vascular device, e.g., affixed to the frame **133**, selectively permeable unit, yoke, skeleton or other radiating support members, the tether, eyelet, etc. to provide identification of the orientation of the device **200** when inside the body of the patient. The radiopaque element can be a bead or clamp. In the case of a clamp, the element can be crimped onto the device **200**. Radiopaque material can be incorporated into wire or tether. Portions of the frame, yoke or permeable unit **132** can be constructed out of DFT wire. Such wire can contain, e.g., a core of tantalum and/or platinum and an outer material of, e.g., Nitinol. Radiopaque elements or fiducial markers provide for advantageous X-ray visibility and navigation, position feedback and control of the device.

(45) In some examples, the tether is proximally extending through an ostium into a selected side vessel such that the tractive force centers the device in relation to the ostium. When pulling the tetherline **300**, it pulls the device at its periphery against the inner wall of the aorta for locking the device in place. In this manner the device is self aligning in relation to the ostium of the selected side vessel thanks to the tether. The skilled person may provide suitable guiding units for the tether when reading this disclosure to obtain this function.

(46) The device may include multiple tethers distally attached along the periphery. Alternatively, or in addition, a single proximal tetherline may separate distally into a plurality of (sub)tetherlines. For instance, a tether may be branched in the form of a Y. A single tether to be operated proximally may then distribute a tractive force distally via its two distal end points to the embolic protection device.

(47) An example with a plurality of endpoints is shown in FIG. **8**. Multiple tethers may be used or

combined with tethers having multiple distal ends. The multiple tethers may be collected proximally at the device, e.g. at a base **330** (FIGS. **7, 8**) thereof. In this manner, the device provides for a progressive force that is evenly distributed along the periphery of the device. The device may in this manner advantageously adapt to the inner shape of the aortic arch **100**. The adaptation may even more enhanced by providing longitudinally elastic portions at the tether(s). For instance, the branched (sub)tetherlines may be provided of elastic material, while the main line is substantially non-elastic, but flexible.

(48) In some examples, the device may have an internal structure or an outer skeleton, such as at least one rib **135** extending between different, preferably opposite, joints at the periphery, wherein the tether is distally attached at the rib. The tether **300** may thus apply a tractive force to the rib **135**, which in turn transfers the force to the periphery **180** of the device **200** towards the aortic inner wall tissue. The rib **135** may be a beam or yoke. It may be arranged longitudinal (FIG. **6, 7**) or transversal (FIG. **4, 5**) in relation to the expanded device's **200** longitudinal axis.

(49) There may be a plurality of such ribs **135** in a device.

(50) For example, this internal structure, e.g., a rib **135**, can permit an operator to control the orientation of the device within the aortic arch and allow the operator to push, press or draw the device against certain features of the aortic arch, e.g., to press the device onto the aortic arch wall at a distance from and over the ostia of one or more of the side vessels. An outer skeleton may be connected to the internal structure. The outer skeleton may be the frame **133** and can provide additional structural support for the device and can facilitate the creation of a seal between the selectively permeable unit **132** of the device and a blood vessel wall. Alternatively, the permeable unit **132** itself may create a seal against the blood vessel wall by extending beyond the perimeter of the frame **133**.

(51) The device **200** may be capable of collapse along its longitudinal axis for ease of delivery to the treatment site. The device **200** may further be compatible with common delivery methods used in interventional cardiology, e.g., TAVI procedures. The device may be integrated into a delivery system, such as including a side channel catheter. Upon retrieval the device **200** may be retracted in orientation substantially similar to the original deployment orientation.

(52) Devices **200** having multiple petals or wings may have one or more ribs on one or more of the petals or wings to obtain a favourable force distribution.

(53) For instance a petal or wing of the device may be arranged upstream in relation to the aortic blood flow. Alternatively, or in addition, the device **200** may have a petal or wing of the device may be arranged downstream in relation to the aortic blood flow. One or more, or each of the petals or wings may have tissue apposition sustaining unit(s), like tethers, pushers, springs as described herein. It may be sufficient to provide petals or wings arranged upstream in relation to the aortic blood flow with tissue apposition sustaining unit(s). Petals or wings arranged downstream may be sufficiently pushed against the aortic inner wall tissue by the pulsatile blood flow in the aorta passing along the blood permeable unit of the device. However, having tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) at petals or wings arranged in downstream direction from a connection point may advantageously be supported by such tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) during pressure changes in the aorta. The aortic pressure is lower during the diastolic phases and may tend to be more leaky than during systolic phases. The tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) may be dimensioned to be sufficient supportive during diastole, and thus be more advantageous (smaller, less mass) for insertion into the body than being dimensioned for systolic pressure support.

(54) The tissue apposition sustaining unit(s) may limit movement of the blood permeable unit **132** caused by the pulsatile blood flow. For instance having a rib **135** may provide for this limited movement range. The rib(s) and/or tether(s) may limit movement of the blood permeable unit. Having connected a tether **300** to the device **200** may provide then for a progressive traction force and particularly improved sealing as forces on the periphery **180** caused by pulsatile pressure changes are evenly distributed during heartbeat's pulsatile flows.

(55) The rib **135** may be a yoke extending proximally above the blood permeable unit **132**. The yoke may preferably extend in a longitudinal direction of at least a portion of the device **200**. The distal tether end(s) may be directly attached to the rib **135**. The distal tether end(s) may be guided by guiding units(s) at the rib to the periphery **180**, providing an advantageous distribution of tractive force.

(56) The device **200** may include multiple tethers, or a single tether splitting distally into multiple strands. In an example two tethers or strands are distally attached to the periphery in a Y-shape from a base of the device (see FIG. **8**).

(57) The device **200** may include at least one eyelet, wherein one or more of the tethers are threaded through at least one eyelet. An eyelet may preferably be provided at a pivot point and/or at a base **330** of the device **200**.

(58) The blood permeable unit may be flexible. It is for example a flat membrane with defined porosity or holes. The porosity or holes may be part of or included in a fine wire netting or mesh, or a perforated film. Such as a mesh or sheet having holes or porosity of 50-950 microns (e.g., 50, 60, 70, 80, 85, 90, 100, 120, 135, 150, 250, 350, 450, 550, 650, 750, 850, 950, or more microns. Perforated film may be perforated prior to the inclusion with the device. The film may also be perforated post inclusion with the device, e.g., by laser drilling or electric sparks. In embodiments where a perforated film is present, the pores can have constant or varied pore patterns, constant or varied pore densities, and/or constant or varied pore sizes. The blood permeable unit **132** may be braided, weaved, clustered, knitted, or knotted. The blood permeable unit **132** may be of a non-degradable material, e.g., polycarbonate, polytetrafluoroethylene (PTFE), expanded polytetrafluoroethylene (ePTFE), polyvinylidene fluoride (PVDF), polypropylene, porous urethane, Nitinol, fluoropolymers (Teflon®), cobalt chromium alloys (CoCr), and para-aramid (Kevlar®), or textile, e.g., nylon, polyester (Dacron®), or silk. The blood permeable unit **132** may be a combination of materials, e.g., the combination of DFT and Nitinol wires. The blood permeable unit **132** may also be coated with an anti-thrombogenic agent to prevent a thrombogenic reaction. The size of the device **200** may be pre-sized and pre-formed to accommodate various patient groups, e.g., children or adults, or a particular aortic anatomy.

(59) A tether may be distally attached to the membrane. A traction force thus applied may raise the membrane out of a plane of the membrane, such that for instance to a volcano shape, including the attachment location of the tether to the membrane at the to thereof. The volcano shape may be advantageously increasing the efficiency of the device. The top of the volcano shape may be arranged to extend into an ostium, into a portion of a side vessel. Trapping of particles may thus be improved by the interior funnel shape of the volcano into which blood flows. Increased filter efficiency will be the result.

(60) The traction unit may include a passive traction unit. The passive traction unit is not operated by an operator, but provides automatically for the improved sealing. The passive traction unit may be a spring. It may have a shape memory element for instance activated by body temperature, such as a portion of the frame, for providing the tractive force relative a delivery portion or device. For instance the device may include “winglets” extending from the periphery of the device which have a shape memory. Another example is shape memory springs that are activated to tension tethers, e.g. from a base of the device. A portion of a tether may be provided as a shape memory portion. Such tether may be delivered in an elongate shape and then change to a memory induced shape, shortening the tether to provide the tensile force. The memory induced shape may be a helical coil shape additionally allowing for elasticity of the memory activated tether, particularly advantageous for pressure and/or movement compensations.

(61) The device may have a flange unit **400** extending radially outward from the periphery **180** of the device **200**, e.g. from the frame **132**, see FIG. **14**. The flange unit may be angled in relation to a plane of the blood permeable unit for a pre-tension against which the tractive force is provided. The flange unit may provide for further improved sealing as sealing is supported by the blood pressure

in the aorta. The flange unit **400** may be made of a fabric. The fabric may be woven. The fabric may be woven from PTFE threads providing for advantageous sealing and biocompatibility. The fabric may be arranged as a collar around the frame of the device. The collar may extend in a direction opposite to a filter membrane attached to the frame. The flange unit **400** provides for reducing or avoiding recesses at the periphery of the device towards the inner wall tissue. This is particularly advantageous as embolic particles may collect in such recesses. These collected particles may then be flushed into the side vessels when the device is removed. Avoiding particles collecting at the periphery reduces this potential issue.

(62) FIG. **10** is a schematic view illustrating a catheter delivered via a femoral approach with a side channel and an embolic protection device with a tether; the device includes hinge portions **340** allowing for an upward movement conversion of the tractive force towards the aortic inner wall tissue, as shown in the Figure. A traction is thus converted into a pushing force.

(63) The tissue apposition sustaining unit may include a pushing unit **350** (FIG. **13**), and the force includes a pushing force, against the frame, periphery and/or blood permeable unit. The pushing unit provides the pushing force and presses the periphery to the inner wall.

(64) The tissue apposition sustaining unit may include a magnetic element and the force includes a magnetic force.

(65) The magnetic force may be provided as follows: the device **200** comprises a magnetic element of a first magnetic polarity. A second magnetic element may be arranged outside of the aortic arch. The second magnetic element has an opposite magnetic polarity than the first magnetic polarity. In this manner, the first and second magnetic elements attract each other. The device **200** will hence be drawn towards the aortic arch wall providing the force improving the sealing of the periphery **180**. The skilled person will recognize suitable timing and locations to apply the second magnetic element. For instance, it may be arranged outside of the body in a suitable direction on the thorax of the patient after the embolic protection device is positioned in the aortic arch.

(66) A repellent magnetic force may be obtained based on the same principle, but with first and second magnetic elements of identical polarity. The second magnetic element may for instance be part of or advanced through the catheter **7** or a side channel thereof when the device **200** is released and positioned from the side channel **7**. In this manner, a force pushing the device against the inner aortic wall is provided.

(67) Magnetic elements may be provided in addition to or alternatively to tethers, pushers, etc.

(68) The medical devices described herein are generally packaged in sterile containers for distribution to medical professionals for use. The articles can be sterilized using various approaches, such as electron beam irradiation, gamma irradiation, ultraviolet irradiation, chemical sterilization, and/or the use of sterile manufacturing and packaging procedures. The articles can be labelled, for example with an appropriate date through which the article is expected to remain in fully functional condition. The components can be packaged individually or together.

(69) Various devices described herein can be packaged together in a kit for convenience. The kit can further include, for example, labelling with instruction for use and/or warnings, such as information specified for inclusion by the Food and Drug administration. Such labelling can be on the outside of the package and/or on separate paper within the package.

(70) The device **200** may be used in a method of positioning an embolic protection device, such as a deflector and/or filter, in the aortic arch, is disclosed. The method includes transluminally delivering the embolic protection device to the aortic arch, the device connected to a transluminal delivery unit **130** extending proximally from a connection point **131** of the device. Further the method includes positioning the device in the aortic arch. The positioning includes expanding a frame of the device and flattening a blood permeable unit in the aortic arch, and bringing a periphery of the device in apposition with an inner wall of the aortic arch to cover ostia of side vessels at least includes the carotid arteries. Thus positioned, the device is preventing embolic particles from passing therethrough into side vessels of the aorta to the brain of a patient.

(71) In an example of a method **600**, the device **200** is positioned in the aortic arch **100** by using a standard Seldinger technique and fluoroscopy with access through an introducer in the left radial artery. Once the collapsible protective device is delivered/released out of the catheter it expands and is placed to cover the left and right carotid arteries, letting through blood but not embolized particles. When the cardiovascular intervention or cardiac operation is over the device is retracted into the catheter again.

(72) In the method **600** of preventing embolic material from entering side branch vessels with a blood flow from an aortic arch of a patient, a collapsible embolic protection device **200** is percutaneously introduced in a collapsed state into a peripheral blood vessel, as illustrated by step **610**. This is schematically illustrated in FIG. **15**. The collapsible embolic protection device **200** is transvascularly delivered in a collapsed state into the aortic arch **100** via the peripheral blood vessel and the first side branch vessel **120**, as illustrated by step **620**. For this purpose, the device **200** is collapsed into a delivery catheter **160** and introduced through the latter to the deployment site inside the aortic arch **100**.

(73) The device **200** is attached to a transvascular delivery unit **130**, such as a pusher or wire, at an attachment point thereof. The embolic protection unit **200** of the collapsible embolic protection device is expanded in the aortic arch **100**, which is illustrated by step **630**.

(74) The expanding may include asymmetrically expanding a first portion **145** of the protection unit and a second portion **146** of the protection unit from the attachment point **131** (see FIG. **1**). The first portion **145** is expanded in a first direction towards the descending aorta **114** of the aortic arch **100**. The second portion **146** is expanded in a second direction towards the ascending aorta **112** of the aortic arch **100**. The asymmetric arrangement facilitates the positioning of the device **200** from the delivery vessel **120** in relation to the other side branch vessels **116**, **118** to be protected. This method stage is illustrated by step **640**.

(75) The positioning the protection unit **200** in the aortic arch **100** includes a positioning a first support member **133** of the selectively permeable unit **132** of the protective unit **200** to tissue of a vessel wall portion of the aortic arch **100**, as illustrated by step **650**. The first support member **133** of the protection unit **200** is at least partly arranged at a periphery **180** of the selectively permeable unit **132** of the protection unit.

(76) The method includes encircling a plurality of ostia of the aortic side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** in the aortic arch **100** with the first support member **133**, and positioning the protective unit **200** at a distance to the ostia. This method stage is illustrated by step **660**.

(77) Thus, the protection unit **200** is positioned in the aortic arch **100** in the expanded state thereof, as illustrated in method step **670**. Embolic material **150** is effectively prevented from passage with a blood flow into a plurality of aortic side branch vessels **116**, **118**, **120** at the aortic arch **100** by the selectively permeable material of the protection unit **200**, see method step **680**.

(78) The method thus provides for concurrently separating a first fluid volume of the aortic side branch vessels from a second fluid volume in the aortic arch when the protection unit **200** is positioned in the aortic arch **100**.

(79) The method may include drawing the expanded protection unit **200** into a direction opposite a delivery direction, and thus tensioning and tightening against a vessel tissue portion of the aortic arch **100** encircling the ostia of the side branch vessels. This embodied method stage is illustrated by step **690**.

(80) Moreover, the method includes a step **700** of applying a force by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of the device, to the device. The force is applied offset to the connection point at the device, such as at the periphery. The force is directed towards an inner wall of the aortic arch when the device is positioned in the aortic arch. In this manner tissue apposition of the periphery to an inner wall of the aortic arch is supported by the force.

(81) This method is less iatrogenic than known methods. It provides for further improved sealing of the periphery of an embolic protection device. It further prevents creation of debris from an ostium

in the aortic arch, which might be an issue with some known embolic protection devices.

(82) The supported apposition is improving apposition of the periphery to the inner wall of the aortic arch, such that the improved apposition provides for improved sealing of the periphery against the inner wall.

(83) The force may be applied in a substantially proximal direction relative the device for the improved sealing.

(84) Applying the force may include applying a tractive force by a traction unit. The tractive force may include pulling a periphery of the device against the inner wall for locking the device in place in the aortic arch. The tractive force may be applied by at least one tether distally connected to the frame, periphery and/or blood permeable unit for providing the tractive force.

(85) The device may be delivered to the aortic arch via one of the side vessels, such as the brachiocephalic artery from the right subclavian artery, the left carotid artery, or the left subclavian artery. It may be delivered to the aortic arch via the descending aorta such as in a femoral approach, e.g. in a side channel of a main catheter. It may be delivered to the aortic arch through the wall of the ascending aorta, which is an approach called “direct aorta” approach.

(86) The device **200** may be used in a method **800** of preventing emboli flowing in the aortic arch from entering side branch vessels thereof, is provided. The method includes a step **801** advancing an embolic protection to the aortic arch; and a step **802** manipulating the protection device such that it covers the ostia of each of the side branch vessels. The method further includes a step **803** applying a force to the protection device for improving sealing of the device at a periphery thereof. Application of the force includes applying a force offset to a connection point at the device by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of the device. In this manner the protection device permits a step **804** blood flow from the aortic arch into each of the side branch vessels, but prevents emboli from entering the first and second side branch vessels without obstructing the lumen of the aortic arch.

(87) The device **200** may be used in a method **810** for limiting the flow of emboli into the carotid arteries from the aorta, is provided. The method includes a step **811** of delivering an embolic protection device to the aortic arch to extend between the ascending aorta and the descending aorta to position the embolic protection device or components thereof into the aortic arch to prevent embolic debris to enter the carotid arteries. Further, it includes a step **812** of proximally tensioning at least one tether member distally connected to the embolic protection device, thus controlling a degree of apposition and fluid sealing of the embolic protection device against the inner vessel wall of the aortic arch.

(88) The device **200** may be used in a method **820** for performing an endovascular procedure on a heart, is disclosed. The method includes a step **821** of delivering an embolic protection device to the aortic arch through one of the following vessels: the brachiocephalic artery from the right subclavian artery, the left carotid artery, the left subclavian artery, or the descending aorta such as in a femoral approach; or through the wall of the ascending aorta. It includes further a step **822** of positioning the embolic protection device into the aortic arch to prevent embolic debris to enter the carotid arteries. The method includes a step **823** of applying a force to the protection device for improving sealing of the device at a periphery thereof, which includes applying a force offset to a connection point at the device by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft of the device. In this manner, the method allows for controlling a degree of apposition and fluid sealing of the embolic protection device against the inner vessel wall of the aortic arch by the applied force. Moreover, the method includes a step **824** of delivering a first catheter through the descending aorta, the left subclavian artery or the aortic vessel wall at the aortic arch to the heart to affect at least a step related to the endovascular procedure on the heart.

(89) The step of applying the force may includes proximally tensioning at least one tether member distally connected to the embolic protection device.

(90) The step of delivering the embolic protection device may be made transluminally, and

delivering the first catheter may be performed after the delivering the embolic protection device.

(91) Delivering the first catheter may include placing a balloon mounted on the first catheter with expanding the balloon in the ascending aortic arch to lock a distal end of the first catheter in place. The balloon may have a donut shape having a filter between the catheter and the inner ring of the donut shape.

(92) The embolic protection device used in the method may extends from a distal end of a second catheter or separate channel of the first catheter, such that the position of the embolic protection device can be independently adjusted from the position of the first catheter.

(93) Delivering a first catheter may be performed concurrently with delivering the embolic protection device via a separate channel of the first catheter, independent of the endovascular procedure.

(94) The endovascular procedure on the heart may includes at least a step related to removal of a heart valve, the placement of a prosthetic heart valve, or repair of a heart valve. This may include the treatment of cardiac valvular disease, like valvuloplasties including percutaneous valve replacement. The procedure may be Transcatheter Aortic Heart Valve (TAVI) involving implantation of a collapsible aortic heart valve with minimally-invasive techniques.

(95) The embolic protection device may be removed from the aortic arch following performance of the endovascular procedure.

(96) The present invention has been described above with reference to specific embodiments. However, other embodiments than the above described are equally possible within the scope of the invention. Different method steps than those described above, performing the method by hardware or software, may be provided within the scope of the invention. The different features and steps of the invention may be combined in other combinations than those described. The scope of the invention is only limited by the appended patent claims.

Claims

1. A method of positioning an embolic protection device, such as a deflector and/or filter, in an aortic arch, including transluminally delivering said embolic protection device to said aortic arch, said device connected to a transluminal delivery unit extending proximally from a connection point of said device; positioning said device in said aortic arch, including expanding a frame of said device and flattening a blood permeable unit in said aortic arch, bringing a periphery of said device in apposition with an inner wall of said aortic arch to cover ostia of side vessels at least including carotid arteries for preventing embolic particles from passing therethrough into side vessels to a brain of a patient; applying a stabilization force by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft arm or bow extending into said aortic arch of said device, wherein said force is applied offset to said connection point at said device, such as at said periphery, and is directed towards an inner wall of said aortic arch providing said stabilization force towards an inner wall of said aortic arch, away from a heart, and in a direction perpendicular to a longitudinal extension of said periphery, when said device is positioned in said aortic arch, such that tissue apposition of said periphery to an inner wall of said aortic arch is supported by said stabilization force for improving stability and peripheral sealing, and applying said supported tissue apposition as improving apposition of said periphery to said inner wall of said aortic arch, such that said improved apposition provides for the improved sealing of said periphery against said inner wall and applying said stabilization force in a substantially proximal direction relative to said device for improved sealing.

2. A method of positioning an embolic protection device, such as a deflector and/or filter, in an aortic arch, including transluminally delivering said embolic protection device to said aortic arch, said device connected to a transluminal delivery unit extending proximally from a connection point of said device; positioning said device in said aortic arch, including expanding a frame of said

device and flattening a blood permeable unit in said aortic arch, bringing a periphery of said device in apposition with an inner wall of said aortic arch to cover ostia of side vessels at least including carotid arteries for preventing embolic particles from passing therethrough into side vessels to a brain of a patient; applying a stabilization force by at least one tissue apposition sustaining unit, not being a delivery shaft arm or bow extending into said aortic arch of said device, wherein said force is applied offset to said connection point at said device, such as at said periphery, and is directed towards an inner wall of said aortic arch providing said stabilization force towards an inner wall of said aortic arch, away from a heart, and in a direction perpendicular to a longitudinal extension of said periphery, when said device is positioned in said aortic arch, such that tissue apposition of said periphery to an inner wall of said aortic arch is supported by said stabilization force for improving stability and peripheral sealing, and applying said supported tissue apposition as improving apposition of said periphery to said inner wall of said aortic arch, such that said improved apposition provides for the improved sealing of said periphery against said inner wall and applying said stabilization force in a substantially proximal direction relative to said device for improved sealing.

3. The method of claim 2, wherein applying said stabilization force includes applying a tractive force by a traction unit.

4. The method of claim 3, including, by said tractive force, pulling a periphery of said device away from said heart against said inner wall for locking the device in place in said aortic arch.

5. The method of claim 3, applying said tractive force by at least one tether distally connected to said frame, periphery and/or blood permeable unit for providing said tractive force.

6. The method of claim 2, wherein said device is delivered to said aortic arch via one of said side vessels, such as a brachiocephalic artery from a right subclavian artery, a left carotid artery, a left subclavian artery, or a descending aorta such as in a femoral approach, or through an ascending aorta.
